

Autolt: An Open Source Software Testing Tool for Windows

The official website of Autolt defines it as a freeware BASIC-like scripting language designed for automating the Windows GUI and general scripting. Autolt runs on all versions of Windows. This third-generation programming language can be used to automate any specific task by simply writing a few lines of script.



It can hardly be denied that many of us are becoming a bit lazy about performing tasks manually, and try our best to make the system do all repetitive tasks to the highest extent possible. If you are running out of time for completing a specific task on some online application within a deadline, you will rely on the system to do so with accuracy, reducing the chance of last minute errors that might creep in if the task is done manually. That is why automation is so important in the current technology-driven era.

Automation testing gauges the quality of software with other tools or software code, which compare the actual outcomes with the predicted outcomes. The entire test suite is run without any manual intervention. The tool itself generates the final outcome of the testing performed in the form of a test report, which features the expected and actual outcomes. The specific method or process that is used to implement the automated process is called a test automation framework. The tool can even help us log defects if required. Automation testing is one of the most happening areas of the software quality assurance industry, as most organisations prefer to rid themselves of manual testing as much as possible. They want to rely on the system or on some tool. Let's have a look at the possible reasons for this.

- Manual testing is time- and cost-consuming when it comes to covering all workflows, all fields and

all negative scenarios. If the same set of validations is performed at different intervals, as in the case of regression testing, then automation testing is quite important.

- Automation testing does not require any human intervention. The automated test suite can be run unattended (even overnight).
- It increases the speed of test execution.
- It increases test coverage.
- Manual testing can also become boring at times and, therefore, it is error prone.

Some open source automation testing tools

There are many options to test any type of software. Some tools are available as open source while some are licensed, for which one has to pay before use. The first choice of any organisation is always for open source tools as they are free of cost. But there are certain limitations associated with these tools, due to which some firms opt for licensed tools. Table 1 lists some open source tools that are being used to test various types of software applications.

The Autolt tool

Autolt is an open source tool that can be used to automate various processes involving Windows and desktop